

# Sonic Boom

**Multimedia speakers for PCs are more than just boxes that emit sound; they're trendy-looking, and are available from the basic two-speaker sets to hi-fi quality 5.1 and even 7.1 sets.**

**This time, we roped in an expert to review our results to make sure you spend your money on the right set**

Jayesh Limaye

**W**hen it comes to buying a PC, speakers were traditionally bundled with mice and keyboards as the components we paid the least attention to.

But that's change a little, and is changing even more. People seem to be getting more interested in quality audio. And if you think about it, that brilliant-looking game is kind of pointless with just stereo speakers, and what's the use of buying movie DVDs if all you have is a 2.1 set?

For this, our annual speaker test, we received 35 sets from eight brands in the 2.1 and 5.1 categories. Though Logitech sent us the entire range of their products—X-230, Z-2300, Z-5300, Z-5450 and Z-5500—only the X-230 worked, and the rest were damaged in transit. Last year's 2.1 Gold Winner, the Altec Lansing MX-5021, shared the same fate. Creative's audiophile sets (the GigaWorks), unfortunately, didn't make it to the test on time.

We brought in an expert from the audio industry for this test, and he took a listen at the best speakers from each category, conducted a few tests, and gave us his verdict. Look for Sunil Karanjikar's comments and results throughout this article for a better understanding of what to expect from your speakers.

